Already and Not Yet

Matthew 5:17–48 · Matthew 7:24–29 · Matthew 13 · John 3:1–8

The big idea: The Sermon on the Mount demands a righteousness no one can reach, and Jesus gives it to everyone who trusts him. Then the Sermon becomes a guide for life in the kingdom. The kingdom is already here and not yet complete, and it is a treasure worth everything.

Before you meet: Read

Matthew 5:17–48 | Matthew 13:31–33, 44–46 | John 3:1–8

Open (5 minutes)

Where do you see the world still broken, even though Jesus has come?

Observe (fill in from the passage)

"Unless your righteousness exceeds that of the scribes and _____, you will never enter the kingdom of heaven." *(Matthew 5:20)*

"Your kingdom come, your _____ be done, on earth as it is in heaven." *(Matthew 6:10)*

"Then in his _____ he goes and sells all that he has and buys that field." *(Matthew 13:44)*

Discuss

1. Jesus said anger and lust break God's law in the heart. How does the Sermon on the Mount work as a mirror for you? *Matthew 5:21–30, 48*

2. If no one can reach the righteousness Jesus requires, how does anyone enter the kingdom? *Matthew 5:20; Philippians 3:9; John 3:3*

3. In Jesus' parables a man sells everything in his joy. What would it look like for you to treat the kingdom as treasure? *Matthew 13:44–46*

Memory verse

"He has delivered us from the domain of darkness and transferred us to the kingdom of his beloved Son"

Colossians 1:13

Pray

Come to God poor in spirit, with nothing to offer but your need. Thank Jesus for the righteousness he gives and the price he paid. Pray, Your kingdom come, your will be done, in your heart, your home, and your church.

LEADER NOTES · WEEK 40

Already and Not Yet

Session plan (about 45 minutes)

5 min	Welcome, opening prayer, and the Open question.
10 min	Read Matthew 5:17–28, 48 and 13:44–46 aloud together.
5 min	Observe: work through the fill-ins together. Use the answer key below.
20 min	Discuss: choose three of the questions.
5 min	Pray together. Introduce the memory verse and next week's reading (Mark 14 and Luke 22:7–20).

Main points to land

1. The Sermon on the Mount first shows that no one reaches God's righteousness, then guides those who receive Christ's righteousness by faith (Matthew 5:20, 48; Philippians 3:9).
2. Jesus lived the Sermon perfectly and died for every line his people have broken. Both his record and his payment are credited to all who trust him (Phil. 3:9).
3. The kingdom is already here and not yet complete. We enter by new birth, repentance, and faith, and we pray, Your kingdom come (John 3:3; Matthew 6:10).

Core doctrine to teach

The Holy Spirit and the New Birth CORE DOCTRINE 20 OF 26

No one can enter God's kingdom by trying harder. We must be born again. The Holy Spirit gives new life to spiritually dead hearts, opens our eyes to see Christ, and makes us willing to trust him. Faith itself is his gift. *John 3:3–8; Ezekiel 36:26–27; Titus 3:5; Ephesians 2:4–5, 8*

Answer key (Observe)

1. Pharisees
2. will
3. joy

Questions people will ask

Do we have to keep the Sermon on the Mount to be saved?

No one can keep it perfectly, and that is the first lesson it teaches (Matthew 5:48). We are saved by faith in Christ, whose perfect obedience and death are credited to us (Philippians 3:9). Then the Sermon becomes a portrait of the new life the Spirit grows in those who belong to Jesus.

Closing prayer

Father, thank you that your kingdom has come in Jesus. We come poor in spirit, with nothing to bring but our need. Thank you for the righteousness your Son gives and the price he paid. Make us citizens who serve, forgive, and move toward the outcast. Your kingdom come, your will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Amen.